FR-DC-SCROG-GHH

Gilded Hog Heresy

A Longsaddle Adventure



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Gilded Hog Heresy

A stolen prize hog. A miraculous swine worshiped by pilgrims. The adventurers must uncover the truth behind the miracle of the Surbrin Hills before the situation turns violent.

A Four-Hour Adventure for Tier 1 Characters. Optimized for APL 3.

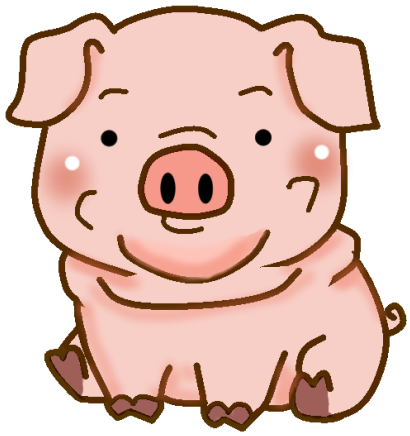
A Longsaddle Adventure.

CONTENT WARNING: Animal endangerment (a hog in peril), fantasy violence, and religious themes.

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Adventure Primer

"Offer prayers to Lathander, and his light will shield thee."

- A statue in Idyllglen

This adventure is designed for **three to seven 1st-4th level characters** and is optimized for **five characters with an average party level (APL) of 3**. Characters outside this level range cannot participate in this adventure.

This adventure is inspired by the song "Ængus, the Prize-Winning Hog" by The Toxhards.

Background

POSIE SWEETROOT, a halfling pig farmer with a competitive streak a mile wide, is fiercely proud of her prize-winning porker, **LATHANDER**, named after the deity of the dawn. In **LONGSADDLE**, swine showmanship is serious business. Farmers spend months grooming their best stock for ribbons, reputation, and bragging rights that can last a generation. Lathander has taken sixteen festival titles and is considered by many to be blessed by the gods. But blessings draw envy as quickly as they draw praise. **JACQUES LE BOUCHER**, a devout follower of **MALAR**, saw a perfect offering to the deity of the hunt. He has offered to buy Lathander many times, and each time Posie has refused him without hesitation. So, Jacques did what any sensible villain would do. He hired outside help to steal the pig.

Unfortunately for him, that help came in the form of the **GOGAN BROTHERS**, a gang of jackalwere charlatans and thieves. Under cover of night, the fiends slipped into Posie's pen and made off with Lathander. But once they laid eyes on the prize-winning hog, their plans changed. Seeing opportunity far greater than a simple payday, the scoundrels devised a new scheme. They would present Lathander as the deity himself. Through staged wonders and honeyed words, they intend to fleece the superstitious and desperate. Jacques was cut out of the bargain entirely as the fiends disappeared with the hog and his advance payment.

Posie awoke to find her pen empty and her world undone. She has pestered neighbors, pleaded with passing wizards, and sought help from anyone willing to listen. A tenday later, folk begin gossiping about a religious gathering miles from the hamlet. A miraculous hog is being hailed as the Morninglord. This sort of news draws all sorts of attention. Both good and bad. Fearing the worst, Posie went to see for herself. There she found her beloved Lathander displayed before cheering crowds, garlanded and glorified. When she demanded the return of her pig, she was shouted down and driven away. Now desperate and running out of options, Posie has taken to the nearest inn in search of adventurers willing to help her reclaim her beloved porker and put an end to the fraud. Meanwhile, Jacques smolders over the betrayal. He takes the jackalweres' treachery not as a setback, but as an omen from Malar. If this is to be a hunt, he will see it through himself.

Overview

The adventure begins with a **Call to Action** scene and has **three parts**. The adventure takes approximately **4 hours** to play.

Call to Action (15 minutes). The characters are eating breakfast at the Gilded Horseshoe where they meet Posie Sweetroot. She begs for their help recovering her stolen prize-winning pig, Lathander.

Part One: The Long Trot (45 minutes). The characters set out for the Lathanderian camp. Unfortunately, adventurers have a long and well-documented tradition of encountering something inconvenient. Overcoming this unexpected nuisance is **Story Objective A.**

Part Two: Morning Bacon (2 hours). The characters arrive at the religious gathering site and attempt to rescue Lathander. Retrieving Lathander is **Story Objective B.**

Part Three: Final Cut (45 minutes). Before the characters can return to Longsaddle, Jacques le Boucher confronts them. Defeating Jacques le Boucher is **Story Objective C.**

Adventure Hooks

Use one of the following adventure hooks to help introduce the characters to the story.

Just Passing Through. The character is traveling through Longsaddle in search of a hot meal, a warm bed, or honest work.

Local to the Region. The character hails from Longsaddle or the surrounding countryside. They know the local faces and just how weird things can get around these parts.

Story Awards

Now and again in this adventure, there's a note nearby explaining how a particular story award is earned or how it might turn up again later to help or trouble the characters. If the note mentions a story award that none of the characters have, just ignore it and keep going.



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Call to Action

Estimated Duration: 15 minutes.

The adventure begins in Longsaddle, a small rural settlement along the Long Road. Longsaddle is a small collection of homes and businesses that cater to travelers heading north to Mirabar or south to Triboar and beyond. Agreeing to help Posie Sweetroot is the **Call to Action.**

Bacon and Eggs

The characters are at the Gilded Horseshoe, a local inn, for breakfast. Read aloud or paraphrase the following:

> The common room smells of bacon grease and fresh bread. Morning light slips in through narrow windows, turning the drifting steam from tin mugs of kaeth and tea to pale gold. Locals and travelers crowd the long tables, trading weather predictions and livestock gossip between mouthfuls of eggs, thick-cut strips of bacon, and crusty bread. Outside, wagons creak past on the road, and somewhere beyond the walls a rooster crows as though offended by the lateness of the hour. Whether by coincidence or quiet familiarity, you find yourselves gathered at the same long wooden table. Before long, a towering red haired human with freckles across her nose and sleeves rolled to the elbow approaches, balancing a tray against her hip. "Mornin'. What'll it be for you fine folk?"

Encourage each player to introduce their character as the human waitress, **Trappy** (**commoner**), moves from seat to seat taking their breakfast orders (provide **Handout 1**).

Area Information

Terrain. The interior of the inn, once a feed barn, consists of a low-beamed common room with long wooden tables, a wide hearth along the far wall, and a narrow stair leading to lofted sleeping quarters above.

Light. Morning sunlight filters through small, shuttered windows, providing bright light throughout the common room. The hearth and a pair of lanterns supplement the light indoors.

Weather. It is summertime. The morning air is warm and slightly humid, with scattered clouds overhead.

Smells and Sounds. The air hangs thick with the smell of frying bacon, fresh-baked bread, and nutty ale. Tin plates clatter, mugs thump against the tables, and the room buzzes with low talk about weather.

Creature Information

After the characters receive their food, **Posie Sweetroot** (small **commoner**) enters the inn. She approaches Trappy and asks whether any adventurers are present in the common room. Trappy gestures toward the characters' table. Upon seeing them, Posie gathers her resolve and makes her way over.

Posie Sweetroot

N halfling (she/her) pig farmer

An anxious halfling with wind-tossed auburn curls, a simple traveler's outfit, and mud-caked boots. She looks as though she has been up for hours without rest. Posie speaks with a Minnesota accent, stretching her vowels and softening her consonants. She often begins sentences with "Oh."

- ***What They Want.*** She wants Lathander back!

Posie Sweetroot introduces herself and explains that thieves stole her prize-winning swine, Lathander, a tenday ago. Her hog, named after the Morninglord, don'tcha know, is the pride of her farm and a champion of sixteen regional festivals. Without him, she risks losing both her livelihood and her reputation. She says she has chased every rumor from here to the crossroads until word reached her yesterday about a miracle pig out at the Surbrin Hills.

So, she saddled up her riding swine and rode straight out to see for herself. Sure enough, there was Lathander. Only he wasn't in a pen. He was standing before a crowd of fools praising and worshipping him like some sort of divine messenger. The whole spectacle was being run by a band of crazy Lathanderians who think he's the genuine article. When Posie tried to reclaim her pig, the crooks chased her clear out of the camp.

She rode back through the night and arrived at the inn this very morning, hoping to the gods that someone here might be willing to help. Lathander has never been away from home this long before, and Posie fears the poor hog must be terrified. With desperation plain on her face, Posie pleads with the characters to help rescue Lathander.



"Oh, that's my Lathander, don'tcha know. I aim to bring him home."
- Posie Sweetroot

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Development

Posie knows the following:

- The camp lies roughly twenty-four miles east of Longsaddle. It should be easy to spot thanks to the gaudy colors and the enormous pig balloon floating above the tents.
- She does not know how many Lathanderians are running the camp, but she reckons the whole bunch might be some sort of cult.
- Many of the folks gathered at the camp are hillfolk and fringe farmers. Plenty of them, she reckons, do not have a lick of sense between them, but there are desperate souls as well. Some are sick and hoping for a cure, while others carry injuries and pray the miracle pig might bring them healing.

Posie offers the characters a reward of **100 gp** and her daddy's old suit of magical plate armor, rest his soul, if they return Lathander safely to her. As an advance, she insists on paying for their breakfast. If the characters agree to help, Posie brightens immediately and says she will be staying at the Gilded Horseshoe until they return with her prize hog.

Bonus Objectives

Word spreads quickly through Longsaddle that the characters have been hired by Posie Sweetroot to recover her missing hog. In a small frontier town, news travels faster than a horse at full gallop, especially when it involves adventurers, a missing prize swine, and the possibility of trouble brewing on the road.

Creature Information

Before long, representatives from several factions begin seeking out the characters. Each messenger carries a sealed letter containing instructions meant only for members of their respective faction. These letters outline additional objectives tied to the events surrounding Lathander's disappearance (give those players **Handout 2**).

Table 1.1: Faction Messengers

Faction	Messenger	Description
Lords' Alliance	**Butters** (CG human male)	An apprentice wizard from Ivy Mansion who speaks with a noticeable lisp. He works for Dowell Harpell, Longsaddle's representative on the council of the Lords' Alliance.
Emerald Enclave	**Cornelius** (N awakened mammoth, male)	An awakened mammoth who now advocates for the natural world in the North. He loves eating corn.
Order of the Gauntlet	**Roadie** (LG dwarf female)	A traveling cleric of Marthammor Duin. Roadie's enormous curly dwarven hair functions like a bag of holding, and she routinely pulls useful items from it such as a flask of whiskey, a folded map of the region, or sealed letters from her faction.
The Harpers	**Bizarro Al** (CG human, androgynous)	A wandering polka bard who secretly serves as a courier for the Harpers. They wear a battered leather jacket covered in metal studs and patches, heavy boots, and sport a tall mohawk while carrying an accordion slung over their shoulder.
The Zhentarim	**Mouse** (LN goliath female)	An intimidating mercenary with ogre-like features who speaks with a thick Cockney accent.

Development

If none of the characters are members of the factions listed above, choose one faction that takes an interest in the characters and attempts to recruit them. A representative of that faction approaches the party and explains that word of their recent hiring has spread through Longsaddle. With trouble stirring outside town, the faction is eager to enlist capable adventurers who can be trusted to act on their behalf. The representative provides the characters with the appropriate sealed letter and briefly explains that the task is connected to the religious gathering at the Surbrin Hills. Characters who accept the request have the option of joining that faction at the end of the adventure.

Table 1.2: Faction Goal

Faction	Story Objective
Lord's Alliance	Find evidence of criminal activity in the region (the ledger in **area B4**).
Emerald Enclave	Convince the Bidderdoos to align with the Emerald Enclave (**area B3**).
Order of the Gauntlet	Convince the pilgrims that the Wollwursts are frauds (**area B1** or **area B9**).
The Harpers	Recruit one of the Wollwurst merchants to act as a Harper informant (**area B2**).
The Zhentarim	Recruit one of the Wollwursts to act as a Zhentarim informant (**area B4**).

It is common for adventuring parties to include characters belonging to different factions. If multiple characters belong to different factions listed in **Table 1.1**, each faction messenger seeks out the appropriate character and delivers their sealed letter.

Story Award

Characters who complete their faction's mission receive the **Story Award (Faction Safehouse, Longsaddle).**

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Part One: The Long Trot

Estimated Duration: 45 minutes.

The journey from Longsaddle to the Lathanderian encampment takes most of the day and carries the characters across open farmland and scattered ranchlands. Rolling pastures stretch to the horizon, broken by fences, wind-bent trees, and the occasional herd of cattle or swine rooting in the mud. As the hours pass, the fields give way to rougher country. Grass grows thinner, the ground turns stony, and low ridges begin to rise from the earth. By the time the characters are near the Surbrin Hills, the land has grown rocky and uneven. That is when the inconvenient random encounter occurs.

Story Objective

Overcoming the unexpected nuisance is **Story Objective A.**

The Surbrin Hills

Read or paraphrase the following:

> The land rises into low hills of stone and scrub, the ground uneven beneath your feet. The day's heat still clings stubbornly to the ground, and the long evening light paints the stones in shades of gold and rust.

Area Information

The area has the following features.

Terrain. Low, rolling hills stretch across the land. The ground is rocky and uneven, dotted with patches of sparse grass and hardy scrub clinging to the dry soil.

Light. It is evening. The sun hangs low on the horizon, though the land is still bathed in bright light.

Weather. The air is hot and windless, with the rocky ground reflecting the day's heat.

Smells and Sounds. Crickets chirp steadily in the brush. The air carries the faint acrid scent of sunbaked stone and dry earth slowly releasing the day's heat.

Maps. **Map 1.1** shows the region. Use **Map 1.2** for this encounter.

Creature Information

The Surbrin Hills are wild and dangerous country, home to barbarian tribes, prowling monsters, and wandering orc warbands. The characters encounter **three** orc **scouts**, **Skrash Faceripper**, **Thrudd Thundercaller**, and **Collin**, and **two dire wolves** stalking game through the hills. The hunters are Hostile and assume the characters may be rivals or threats. A character can use the Influence action to avoid a conflict, making a Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, Persuasion, or Performance) check. This check is made with Advantage if the character speaks Orc or if any member of the party is an orc. On a success, the orcs stand down and allow the characters to pass without further trouble.

On a failure, the orcs attack. If questioned about the Lathanderian encampment, they can share the following:

- Many folk gather there. Most are sick, wounded, or near death.
- They sing to a pig like it's a god. Strange behavior.
- Wolves won't go near that place. Bidderdoo hunts there, a cursed beast. The Bidderdoos are werewolves that have plagued the orc warbands of the Surbrin Hills for generations.
- There's a shrine to the Beast Lord in those hills. Predators go there to die.

The orcs can provide directions to the encampment but refuse to go near it. A successful DC 10 Intelligence (Religion) check identifies the Beast Lord as Malar, deity of the hunt and savage beasts.

Adjusting the Scene

Here are some suggestions for adjusting a scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove all **dire wolves.**
- **Weak.** Remove **one dire wolf.**
- **Average. Three scouts, two dire wolves.**
- **Strong**. Add **one dire wolf.**
- **Very Strong.** Replace all **scouts** with **scout captains.**

Story Award

If any character possesses the **Story Award (Watch the Skies),** the orcs recognize them and accuse the party of sending the copper dragon, Ol' Stinkybutt, to torment their warband with pranks. Characters with this Story Award have Disadvantage on checks made as part of the Influence action during this encounter.

Treasure

The skeletal remains of a human traveler lie nearby, their belongings scattered across the ground. Among them are a priest's pack, a mace, and a holy symbol (amulet) depicting a road leading into a sunrise. A successful DC 10 Intelligence (Religion) check identifies it as the symbol of the deity of dawn and renewal, Lathander. The orcs refuse to disturb the remains, holding a superstition against looting the corpse of a priest.

If the characters loot the orc hunters, they find three studded leather armors, three longbows, and three shortswords.

Development

Once the characters resolve this encounter, proceed to **Part 2: Morning Bacon.**

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Part Two: Morning Bacon

Estimated Duration: 2 hours.

If the characters choose not to rest and continue traveling, they arrive at the Lathanderian encampment around nightfall. Otherwise, they reach the camp the following day in the morning. The situation at the camp differs depending on when the characters approach. During the day the camp is busy and active, while at night activity slows and the jackalweres rely on their trained beasts to watch over the grounds.

Story Objective

Retrieving Lathander is **Story Objective B.**

The Lathanderian Encampment

If the characters choose to arrive at the encampment at night, read or paraphrase the following:

> Lantern light flickers across a patchwork sprawl of wagons, tents, and cooking fires spread along the rocky foothills. Beyond the outer camps of pilgrims and wanderers stands a cluster of gaudy canvas pavilions painted in bright colors that seem determined to be seen from several miles away. Above it all floats a giant pig-shaped balloon, gently bobbing in the night sky. Most of the crowd has settled in for the night. Low murmurs drift between the campfires where sick folk, hopeful pilgrims, and the curious have pitched their bedrolls.

If the characters choose to arrive at the encampment during the day, read or paraphrase the following:

> The encampment sprawls across the foothills like a traveling carnival that has collided with a temple fair. Rain falls steadily from a gray sky, turning the dusty ground to mud as colorful banners hang heavy and dripping while a massive pig-shaped balloon bobs overhead. Crowds of humanoid pilgrims, orcs, and wandering Uthgardt press toward a large striped pavilion at the center of the encampment. Some limp, others cough, and many clutch charms or holy symbols while hoping for a miracle despite the soaking rain.

Area Information

The area has the following features.

Terrain. The camp sits among low rocky hills where patches of stubborn grass grow between stone and scrub. Tents, wagons, and makeshift shelters fill the flatter ground, while narrow paths wind between cooking fires and clusters of pilgrims.

Lighting. Unless otherwise noted, at night the camp is lit only by scattered campfires and torches mounted on staked poles. During the day, the area is in bright light. Inside the tents, torches mounted on staked poles provide illumination.

Weather. The heat grows worse at night as humidity rises. By morning the humidity breaks and steady rain begins, continuing throughout the day.

Smells and Sounds. The camp smells of wet canvas, wood smoke, livestock, and too many bodies crowded together. The constant murmur of prayers, coughing pilgrims, and restless animals fills the air.

Maps. Use **Map 2.1** for the encampment.

Creature Information

There are **fifteen Gogan Brothers** (**jackalweres**) at the encampment. The Gogans present themselves to the public as the Wollwurst family, a cheerful troupe of traveling Lathanderians who claim to have discovered the miracle hog deep within the Neverwinter Wood. According to their story, the pig revealed itself as a divine vessel of the Morninglord and now travels with the family to bring blessings and healing to the faithful. Most pilgrims see only a traveling religious show and assume the Wollwursts are harmless eccentrics. In truth, the entire operation is a carefully staged swindle designed to collect donations from desperate believers. In addition to Common, the jackalwere know Thieves' Cant. **Wendelwella** (CE **doppelganger**) leads the Gogan Brothers.

Wendelwella Gogan

CE doppelganger (they/them) cursed jackalwere

Wendelwella most often appears as a tall woman with fair skin, long blonde hair, and striking green eyes, dressed in frontier clothing. In truth, Wendelwella is a jackalwere who can no longer assume their jackal form. Years ago, they offended a powerful lamia from Anauroch, who cursed them to live without a true form. While Wendelwella can still fluidly change between different humanoid identities, they cannot return to their natural jackal body.

- ***What They Want.*** Wendelwella wants to earn enough coin to lift the curse and return to their true form. Many of the other Gogans support this goal and commit various crimes to help raise the money.
- ***Restless.*** Wendelwella does not need mundane sleep and can remain active at any hour.

The Gogans' human forms tend to have fair skin, blonde to brown hair, and green or brown eyes. They dress in simple frontier clothing, including homespun shirts, wool vests, patched trousers or long skirts, sturdy boots, and wide-brimmed hats. Despite the name "Gogan Brothers," the jackalweres freely adopt male or female forms, or a mix of the two, depending on the role they are playing.

At night, **two Gogans** guard Lathander in **area B8** while disguised in human form. **Two Gogans** in jackal form patrol the encampment. The remaining jackalwere sleep in the wagons at **area B4.** During the day, **eight Gogans** work the show at **area B9** while the others wander the encampment dealing with pilgrims. The Gogans who were awake during the night sleep in the wagons at **area B4** during the day.

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TABLE 3.1: THE GOGAN GANG

Jackalwere	Description
Buford	Dumb as an ox who spends long stretches staring at his own belly as if deep in thought.
Burl	Enjoys playing the role of a helpful guard and finds creative ways to say no without actually saying no.
Cletus	A lazy jackalwere who prefers sleeping under the wagons and complains loudly whenever they have to work.
Darla	They assist Wendelwella in tracking the pack's money and quietly pocket a few extra coins whenever no one is looking.
Earl	Enjoys telling exaggerated stories about miracles performed by the holy hog.
Hollis	A soft-spoken jackalwere who pretends to be a humble preacher.
Jeb	A cheerful troublemaker who plays the piano.
Loretta	A jackalwere who despises their human form and spends nearly all her time in jackal shape.
Lurlene	A dramatic jackalwere who weeps loudly whenever emotional.
Mack	A suspicious jackalwere who constantly watches the pilgrims and assumes every traveler might be a spy.
Otis	A practical jackalwere who handles the wagons, props, and stage equipment for the miracle hog show.
Skeeter	A scrawny jackalwere who twitches constantly and rarely finishes a sentence in a way anyone understands.
Tilda	A jackalwere who likes to take on the guise of a kindly grandmother.
Waylon	The youngest of the pack, who takes great pride in their loud howls and can never resist joining in whenever another jackal starts one.
Virgil	A cowardly jackalwere who jumps at the slightest noise and would rather run than fight.

SOUNDING THE ALARM

If the Gogans become aware of raiders, troublemakers, or rival scoundrels in the encampment, they raise the alarm. Within 1d4 rounds, **seven jackalweres** from **area B4** assemble a hunting party and move to confront the characters.

ADJUSTING THE SCENE

Here are some suggestions for adjusting a scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove **three jackalweres.**
- **Weak.** Remove **two jackalweres.**
- **Average. Seven jackalweres.**
- **Strong**. Replace **one jackalwere** with a small **gnoll pack lord**.
- **Very Strong.** Replace another **jackalwere** with a small **gnoll pack lord**.

STORY AWARD

Any character with the **Story Award (Gogan Brothers Gang Feud)** is immediately recognized by the jackalweres as an enemy of their gang. If such a character is present, the Gogans attempt to rally their allies and target that character first.

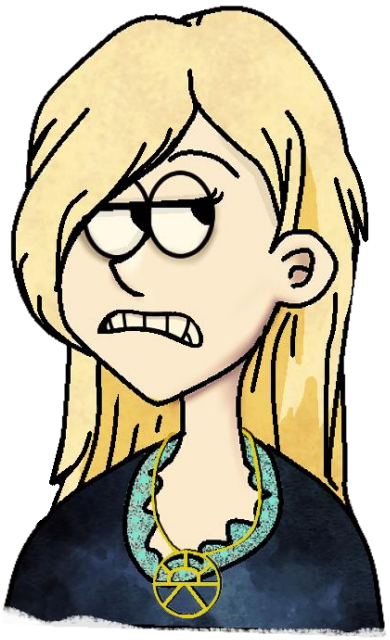
THE GOGAN BROTHERS GANG

The Gogan Brothers are a loose-knit band of jackalweres known for their shifting identities and coordinated criminal schemes. Originally hailing from the sands of Anauroch, the Gogans have migrated to the west and can be found across the Dessarin Valley region. Rather than operating as a single gang, the Gogans break into smaller packs, each working a different stretch of road, village, or frontier settlement. They favor confidence tricks over open violence, posing as adventurers, merchants, performers, or even simple farmers to win trust before striking. When threatened, however, their cruelty shows quickly.

Unlike most jackalweres, the Gogans regularly adopt other humanoids into their ranks. Drifters, criminals, and desperate souls are welcomed so long as they prove useful and loyal. These recruits are treated like lesser siblings, often unaware of the gang's true nature until it is far too late to leave.

All Gogans answer, in one way or another, to a shadowy matron known only as "Ma." Her true nature is a matter of rumor. Some say she is a lamia of terrible power, others whisper she is a fiend or something older still. Whatever the truth, Ma's influence binds the scattered packs together, and her will is carried out through her favored agents.

Though they often bicker and compete like squabbling siblings, the Gogans unite swiftly against outside threats. To cross one pack is to risk the attention of them all.



"I can be anyone... except for what I truly am."
- Wendelwella Gogan

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Exploring the Encampment

The following locations are keyed to **Map 2.1.**

B1. Pilgrim Encampment

The outer edges of the encampment are filled with pilgrims who have traveled from distant farms, villages, and from the Surbrin Hills. Many have come seeking a miracle, while others simply hope to witness the strange spectacle of the supposed miracle hog.

Area Information

Clusters of small tents, bedrolls, and lean-tos surround the main encampment. Sick folk lie beneath blankets while family members tend cooking fires or whisper hopeful prayers. Many pilgrims wait patiently for the next opportunity to witness the miracle pig, believing it may cure their ailments or bless their fortunes.

Creature Information

Use the **commoner** stat block to represent these creatures, who are a mix of different species. If the characters speak with the pilgrims, they can learn the following information:

- The miracle hog performs once each morning beneath the large pavilion in the center of the encampment. Crowds gather whenever the bell rings.
- The show is run by the Wollwurst family, a cheerful troupe of Lathanderians from Neverwinter who claim the hog is the avatar of the Morninglord.
- The Wollwursts do not allow anyone near the hog outside the performances. They say they must protect the Morninglord from outside interference.
- Many pilgrims have come seeking relief from their troubles. Some suffer from debilitating coughs, stubborn skin rashes, lingering aches, or minor curses that local priests could not remove. Each hopes the miracle hog might grant them the healing they could not find elsewhere.

Order of the Gauntlet Faction Mission

A character who spends at least 10 minutes speaking with the pilgrims and succeeds on a DC 13 Charisma (Deception, Persuasion) or Intelligence (Religion) check convinces several of them that something is wrong with the Wollwursts. Suspicion spreads quietly through the camp as uneasy whispers pass from tent to tent. As a result, characters attempting to sway the angry mob in **area B9** gain Advantage on Charisma checks made as part of the Influence action. If the characters never confront the crowd in **area B9,** the quiet doubt they plant among the pilgrims is enough to fulfill the Order of the Gauntlet faction mission.

To further complicate matters, **Jacques le Boucher** (**scout captain**) has arrived ahead of the characters and now lurks among the pilgrims disguised as a leper. The hunter watches and waits for the right moment to reclaim what he believes should have been his prize all along. Jacques is likely the first to notice the characters within the pilgrim camp and suspect that something is amiss. He follows them quietly through the encampment. Characters with a passive Perception of 14 or higher notice the "leper" shadowing them at a distance. Jacques eventually reveals himself and offers to assist them, claiming that the hog rightfully belongs to him. If the characters refuse his help, Jacques withdraws and waits for them to secure the pig before striking, attempting to take the animal for himself.

Jacques Le Boucher

CE human (he/him) Malarite

Jacques is a short, bald human with salt-and-pepper mutton chops and a stringy beard. He wears animal furs and leather and resembles a hardened frontier hunter. Disguised as a leper, he appears ghastly and carries the foul odor of someone who has not bathed in months. Jacques speaks in a caricatured Hollywood French accent.

- ***What They Want.*** Jacques believes that sacrificing Lathander the pig will earn him glory in the eyes of the Beast Lord.

Adjusting the Scene

Against parties of Very Weak and Weak strength, replace Jacques's stat block with a **scout.**

NPC Names

If you need a quick name for a pilgrim, choose one of the following: Arnak, Old Bram, Brolgar, Hilda, Hroth, Toe, Merle, Hillman, Lysa, Corin, Marta, Turnip, Bessa, Reed, Clayfoot, Fenbarrow, Dove, Alderstep, or Torgha.



"Zat pig... it belongs to me, oui."
- Jacques le Boucher

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B2. Merchant Camp

The Gogans have set up this area to sell merchandise and charms to the pilgrims.

Area Information

Four wagons display colorful trinkets, carved wooden pigs, painted prayer tokens, and cheap holy symbols said to bring the Morninglord's favor. Painted banners show smiling pigs surrounded by golden rays. Pilgrims crowd around the stalls while merchants enthusiastically demonstrate their wares.

Table 3.2 Trinkets for Sale

Trinket	Cost
A small wooden carving of a smiling pig.	5 cp
A painted wooden disc stamped with a rising sun symbol.	2 cp
A small pouch filled with colorful, sweet popcorn.	2 cp
A carved wooden pig snout worn over the face with a cord tied around the head.	1 gp
A cup of cheap wine sold at an outrageous price.	1 gp

Creature Information

Four merchants (**commoner**) loudly advertise their wares. The human merchants speak quickly and enthusiastically, praising the miracle hog. These merchants are human associates of the Gogan Brothers' gang and are aware they're working with fiends. While the jackalweres handle the deception and security of the encampment, the humans manage the chores of the camp and deal with the pilgrims directly.

Table 3.3: The Merchants

Merchants	Description
Calvin	A fast-talking trinket merchant who is always dreaming up a new promotion to hawk his wares.
Lenior	She is constantly cheerful and enjoys quoting Lathanderian proverbs and praises.
Reese	She clearly hates mornings and has no patience for the miracle hog nonsense, but sells her goods with practiced efficiency anyway.
Tater	A loud, red-faced merchant who sells his wares with the booming enthusiasm of a motivational speaker convinced the miracle hog can change your life.

If the characters speak with the merchants, they can share the following.

- The miracle hog has the power to cure ills, heal the injured, and remove curses.
- The merchants claim the Wollwurst family discovered the miracle hog deep within the Neverwinter Wood. They say the pig revealed itself as the avatar of the Morninglord.
- The merchants encourage visitors to purchase merchandise to support their holy mission, explaining that the funds help spread the Morninglord's blessing across the land.

Development

Using the Search action, a successful DC 10 Wisdom (Insight) check suggests the story sounds rehearsed. If confronted, the merchants complain that they are only doing their job. If a character presses them for more information using the Influence action and succeeds on a DC 12 Charisma (Intimidation) check, the merchant admits the story about the miracle hog is not true. They can share the following:

- The Wollwurst family is simply a stage name used by the performers running the show. The merchant explains they were hired in Triboar by the Gogan Brothers, a traveling troupe of entertainers, to help manage the crowds and sell merchandise to the pilgrims. The merchant claims the Gogans are harmless showfolk who make their living by putting on strange spectacles for curious travelers.
- The troupe's leader, Wendelwella, suffers from a strange affliction. The Gogans have been gathering coin in hopes of finding someone capable of curing it. The merchant does not know the details of the condition, only that Wendelwella rarely shows their true face in public.
- The merchant admits the whole show is a bit of a swindle. Still, they argue that no one is being forced to pay. Pilgrims drop coin in the bowl because they want to believe they have witnessed something special.

A character who succeeds on a DC 14 Intelligence (History) check recalls hearing about the Gogan Brothers, a roaming gang of jackalweres known for small cons, crooked games, and occasional livestock rustling.

If the characters accuse the Gogans of being jackalweres, the merchants deny the claim and dismiss it as nonsense. If the characters continue pressing the matter or behave suspiciously, the merchants grow nervous. At the first opportunity, one of them slips away to warn the Gogans that troublemakers are asking questions, triggering **Sounding the Alarm.**

Harper Faction Mission

A character may attempt to privately recruit one of the merchants as an informant. The most likely candidates are Reese, who dislikes the miracle hog operation, or Calvin, whose loyalty lies more with profit than with the Gogans. A character who spends at least 10 minutes speaking with a merchant and succeeds on a DC 13 Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, or Persuasion) check convinces the merchant to secretly cooperate with the Harpers. The merchant refuses to act openly against the Gogans but agrees to pass along information about the gang's movements and scams in the future. Recruiting one of the merchants as an informant fulfills the Harper faction mission.

Treasure

If the characters loot the merchants, each merchant carries a club. A locked money box can be found in a wagon of your choice, containing **100 gp** in assorted coins. The lock on the chest can be picked with thieves' tools using a DC 15 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check.

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B3. The Hermit

High in the rocky hills overlooking the encampment sits a lone watcher hidden among the boulders.

Area Information

This campsite consists of a flattened patch of dirt surrounded by large rocks and scrubby grass. A crude fire pit filled with cold ashes sits near the center of the camp. Nearby lie scattered animal bones.

Creature Information

Ravenwing (CG **werewolf**) watches the encampment from this vantage point while in wolf form. Ravenwing is a member of the Bidderdoos, a pack of good-aligned werewolves sworn to protect the Longsaddle region and the surrounding wilderness. For generations, the Bidderdoos have opposed the Gogan Brothers. The jackalweres' schemes, scams, and predatory nature have long brought them into conflict with the werewolf pack. Ravenwing has been tracking the Gogan Brothers for several days and has followed their trail to the encampment. The werewolf suspects the religious gathering is another of the Gogans' many cons. For now, Ravenwing studies the camp from afar, counting guards and watching patrol routes while preparing to return to his pack with what he has observed.

Ravenwing remains hidden unless the characters approach the hilltop or begin searching the area. If discovered, the werewolf initially assumes the characters might be allies of the jackalweres and is Hostile. If the characters convince Ravenwing that they are not allied with the Gogans, the werewolf changes into hybrid form and shares what they know.

- Jackalweres are shapeshifting fiends that delight in deception, cruelty, and trickery. They prefer lies and schemes over open combat.
- Ravenwing cautions that jackalweres can assume human form and possess a dangerous gaze capable of lulling their victims into a magical sleep.
- The Gogan Brothers are a wandering clan of jackalweres known across the frontier for murder, livestock rustling, and swindling humanoids. The family has numerous branches and offshoots, and no one seems entirely sure how many Gogans there really are.
- Ravenwing has counted fifteen jackalweres, their leader Wendelwella, and five human conspirators living in the encampment.
- The Gogans sometimes recruit ordinary humans to assist with their schemes, such as the merchants in the encampment. He advises the characters not to trust them.
- According to rumor, Wendelwella cannot assume a jackal form like other jackalweres. Ravenwing cautions that most jackalweres can only assume human form, while Wendelwella is said to take on the appearance of any humanoid.

Ravenwing

CG elf werewolf (he/him) Bidderdoo scout

Ravenwing is a venerable old werewolf with a coat of dark gray fur streaked with silver. Though age has slowed his body, Ravenwing's instincts remain keen. Ravenwing tries to maintain a dignified demeanor, but occasionally forgets himself and begins absentmindedly scratching behind his ear with a hind leg.

- ***What They Want.*** Ravenwing wants the Gogan Brothers driven out of the region before more innocent pilgrims are harmed. A longtime member of the Bidderdoos of Longsaddle, he has spent decades protecting the surrounding frontier from predators and monsters.

Emerald Enclave Faction Mission

A character who spends at least 10 minutes speaking with Ravenwing and succeeds on a DC 13 Charisma (Persuasion or Nature) check convinces the werewolf to consider an alliance with the Emerald Enclave. If persuaded, Ravenwing agrees to carry word of the faction to the Bidderdoos. If the characters fail the check, Ravenwing remains wary of the offer. However, the werewolf is willing to reconsider if the characters slay Wendelwella, the leader of this band of jackalweres. Recruiting Ravenwing fulfills the Emerald Enclave faction mission.

Development

Ravenwing's mission is not to interfere but to observe. He intends to return to his pack with what he has learned so the Bidderdoos can act together. The old werewolf refuses to strike while innocent pilgrims remain caught in the middle.

Treasure

If the characters loot the werewolf, they can find a longbow.



"This region will not know peace while the Gogans remain here."
- Ravenwing

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B4. Jackalwere Camp

These wagons serve as the sleeping quarters of the "Wollwursts" family.

Area Information

The area has the following features.

Wagons. Six covered wagons contain sleeping cots, travel chests, and crates filled with colorful costumes, painted props, and stage equipment used in the miracle show.

Wendelwella's Wagon. One wagon serves as Wendelwella's residence. Choose any of the six covered wagons in **area B4** to represent it. Unlike the others, it is kept relatively orderly. Inside are a sturdy cot, a small writing desk, a locked chest, and an accounting ledger recording the coin collected from their scams. The ledger is written in Thieves' Cant. A character who studies the book and succeeds on a DC 10 Intelligence (Investigation) check recognizes the coded markings for what they are.

Otherwise, the ledger appears to be nothing more than a personal journal describing various villages and landmarks along the Long Road. The most recent entry recounts how the family found faith in Lathander after encountering the pig. It goes on to describe the challenges of a traveling religious show and the many wonderful pilgrims they have met along the way.

If the characters can read Thieves' Cant, the ledger records donations collected from pilgrims along with notes about past scams, livestock thefts, and locations where the Gogan Brothers previously operated. The lock on the chest can be picked with thieves' tools using a DC 15 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check.

Creature Information

At night, **eleven jackalweres** sleep here. During the day, most of the Gogans work elsewhere in the encampment, while **four jackalweres** from the night shift sleep here instead. If the Gogans become aware of intruders, they raise the alarm (see **Sounding the Alarm**). During this adventure, Wendelwella is rarely found in her wagon and instead remains close to Lathander.

Lords' Alliance Faction Mission

The Lords' Alliance seeks evidence of criminal activity threatening the stability of the frontier. The ledger in Wendelwella's wagon can be turned over to the Harpells in Longsaddle as proof of the gang's activities. Recovering the ledger fulfills the Lords' Alliance faction mission.

Zhentarim Faction Mission

The Zhentarim value useful contacts. A character pursuing this mission may attempt to recruit one of the jackalweres as an informant for the Black Network. If the characters capture or privately speak with a jackalwere here and succeed on a DC 13 Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, or Persuasion) check, the creature agrees to provide information to the Zhentarim in exchange for coin and protection. The jackalwere refuses to betray the Gogans immediately but promises to pass along information about the gang's movements and schemes in the future. Recruiting a jackalwere informant fulfills the Zhentarim faction mission.

Treasure

If the characters ransack the wagons, they can find a set of carpenter's tools, cook's utensils, leatherworker's tools, painter's supplies, and weaver's tools. They also uncover a diplomat's pack, disguise kit, a forgery kit, two healer's kits, three sets of fine clothes, sixteen sets of traveler's clothes, and three dice sets. Wendelwella's chest contains **285 gp** in assorted coins.

B5. Pig Balloon

This balloon serves as both a landmark and a piece of outrageous advertising, visible for miles across the hills.

Area Information

A tall wooden post driven deep into the rocky soil anchors the massive pig balloon that floats above the camp. The balloon is secured with several thick ropes tied to iron rings driven into the post. Cutting or untying the ropes releases the balloon.

Development

If the balloon is released, it quickly drifts across the hills, creating a great distraction. Half of the jackalweres in the camp immediately scramble after it in a panic, chasing their prized advertisement across the countryside. These jackalweres are removed for the remainder of the day and return the following morning, tired and extremely irritated.

B6. Old Shrine

In the rocky hills overlooking the encampment stands a crude shrine devoted to Malar.

Area Information

The area has the following features.

Terrain. A rough stone altar stands among wind-carved rocks. The ground around the shrine is littered with the skeletal remains of predatory beasts. Nearby, a low cairn of stacked stones marks a shallow grave. Carved into the altar is the crude symbol of a clawed hand. A character who takes the Study action and succeeds on a DC 10 Intelligence (Religion) check recognizes the symbol of Malar, deity of the hunt and savage beasts.

Dread. This place is hallowed ground to the Beast Lord. The air feels heavy and wrong, as if the land itself remembers the violence done here. Characters standing near the shrine may feel a prickling along the skin, like the uneasy sense of being watched.

Treasure

If the characters dig up the grave, they uncover a **Nature's Mantle**. The cloak bears the **repulsive quirk** and carries a pungent boar musk odor that clings stubbornly to it. Curiously, the wearer is the only one who can smell it.

In the grave lie the skeletal remains of a tusked orc. If the characters do not recover the cloak here, Jacques le Boucher later carries the Nature's Mantle in **Part Three: Final Cut.**

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B7. The Talent's Tent

This modest tent serves as the residence of the Gogans' illusionist, who is responsible for many of the "miracles" witnessed during the show.

Area Information

The interior of the tent is cluttered with empty wine bottles scattered across the ground, along with corks, stained cups, and crumbs from half-eaten trail rations. The air smells strongly of cheap wine and stale food.

Creature Information

At night, **Waggledort Talonmist** (**illusionist wizard**) is usually found here asleep after an evening of drinking wine. His **weasel** familiar, **Slinket**, remains nearby and wakes him if intruders enter the tent. During the day, Waggledort can be found either at **area B9** assisting with the miracle show or wandering the encampment disguised as a pilgrim using *disguise self.* In this guise, he mingles with the crowd, listens for rumors, and keeps watch for anyone who might threaten the Gogans' operation. Feel free to place Waggledort wherever it best suits the scene. His familiar remains in the tent during the day unless Waggledort calls for it.

Treasure

The tent contains a set of fine clothes, Waggledort's spellbook, an arcane focus (orb), a scholar's pack, a **Spell Scroll of Antagonize** in a scroll case, and seven empty glass bottles.

Waggledort Talonmist

CN human (he/him) illusionist

Waggledort wears loose blue robes and a crooked wizard's hat that never seems to sit straight. His eyes are often half-lidded, and he carries himself like someone recovering from a particularly terrible hangover.

- ***What They Want.*** Waggledort is a hired illusionist working for the Gogan Brothers. His job is to create convincing "miracles" during the performances and keep the crowd impressed. While he occasionally feels uneasy about deceiving desperate pilgrims, the Gogans pay well and provide a generous supply of wine, which has done wonders for his conscience.
- ***Disguised Pilgrim.*** If Waggledort becomes aware that the characters intend to steal the miracle pig or otherwise disrupt the Gogans' operation, the disguised wizard quietly slips away and reports the news to the jackalwere in **area B4** (see **Sounding the Alarm**).

Adjusting the Scene

Replace Slinket's creature type with fey. Against parties of Very Weak strength, Waggledort surrenders if threatened with violence.

B8. The Morninglord's Tent

This tent houses the cage where Lathander is kept between performances. During the day, the tent stands empty. Read or paraphrase the following if the characters arrive here at night:

> Inside the tent, a sturdy wooden cage sits at the center of the space, draped with bright cloth meant to look festive. Within the cage stands a plump pig with a curly tail and bright, curious eyes. Beside the cage stands a familiar halfling, arms folded as she watches the pig with quiet attention. Posie Sweetroot.

Area Information

A wooden cage sits at the center of the pavilion, draped with colorful cloth. When the show is not underway, the pig rests here. The cage is secured with a lock that can be picked with thieves' tools using a DC 15 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check.

Creature Information

At night, **Lathander** (**boar**) rests here inside the cage. During the day, the pig is brought to **area B9** to participate in the show. Lathander appears friendly and excited to see visitors, wagging his small curly tail and snorting happily. In the tent with Lathander stands Posie Sweetroot. In truth, this is **Wendelwella** (CE **doppelganger**) in disguise, using the halfling's appearance to keep the pig calm and cooperative. The pig trusts the face and scent of its beloved owner, and Wendelwella uses that trust to manipulate the animal into performing at the show.

Wendelwella is Hostile if intruders are noticed and demands the characters leave the tent. If it becomes clear the characters intend to take the pig, Wendelwella attacks. **Two jackalweres** in human guise also stand watch over Lathander.

Adjusting the Scene

Here are some suggestions for adjusting a scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove all **jackalweres.** Reduce **Wendelwella's** Hit Points to 30. She doesn't use Multiattack.
- **Weak.** Remove **one jackalwere.**
- **Average. Wendelwella** (**doppelganger**), **two jackalweres.**
- **Strong**. Replace **one jackalwere** with a small **gnoll pack lord**.
- **Very Strong.** Replace another **jackalwere** with a small **gnoll pack lord**.

Lathander the Pig

Change the boar's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Reduce the boar's Hit Points to 6.
- It doesn't use Gore and doesn't have the Bloodied Fury trait. It has no effective attacks.

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B9. Worship Pavilion

This large pavilion stands at the center of the encampment and serves as the stage for the miracle show. If the characters arrive during the day and choose to watch the show, read or paraphrase the following:

> The striped pavilion is packed shoulder to shoulder with pilgrims bearing hopeful expressions. Rain patters softly against the canvas roof while colorful banners bearing the rising sun of the Morninglord sway from the tent poles. Inside stands a small wooden stage lit by lanterns. A red-haired human in flamboyant robes strides forward, arms raised dramatically.
>
> "Faithful seekers!" the preacher proclaims. "You have traveled far through hardship and doubt, but this morning you shall witness a wonder blessed by the Morninglord himself!"
>
> A drumroll rattles from somewhere behind the stage. Standing beside him, a red-haired woman dressed in matching robes grips a curtain rope and flashes a confident smile to the crowd. With great ceremony she throws the curtain open, revealing a plump pig wearing a bowtie. The crowd gasps as she gestures grandly toward the animal.
>
> "Behold! The living sign of dawn's mercy! The sacred vessel of the Morninglord's grace! The miracle hog… Lathander!"
>
> The pig snorts loudly as the pilgrims erupt into cheers, prayers, and a frantic rain of coins tossed toward the stage.

Area Information

Inside is a small wooden stage where the Gogans present their sermons and displays of divine wonder. Near the side of the stage is a small upright piano mounted on a wheeled platform. Colorful banners bearing symbols of the Morninglord hang from the tent poles. At night, the pavilion is vacant. During the day, however, the tent fills quickly with pilgrims and curious onlookers eager to witness the Morninglord. There is a discreet rear entrance (**area B9a**) to the worship pavilion that allows the Gogans to escort Lathander between tents without passing through the crowd.

Creature Information

Eight jackalweres in human guise work the crowd in this area. Two perform on stage as preachers, one plays the piano to accompany the show, another moves through the audience collecting donations in a bowl, and the remaining three are disguised as pilgrims and mingle among the onlookers, waiting to step forward when the preachers call for volunteers during the miracle. Waggledort remains hidden behind the stage at **area B9a**, using illusion magic to create the appearance of divine miracles. If Waggledort is not present, the jackalweres improvise with exaggerated theatrics to maintain the illusion.

At several points during the show, the jackalweres call for volunteers. The planted accomplices step forward on cue. One claims to suffer from aching joints, another from failing eyesight, and a third from a lingering cough. Each approaches the stage, kneels before the miracle hog, and after a brief flourish of illusion magic declares themselves miraculously cured. The pilgrims erupt in cheers and renewed devotion.

During the performance, one jackalwere moves through the crowd carrying a collection bowl and politely asking for donations to support the Morninglord's campaign. Characters may donate coins, refuse without consequence, or attempt to steal from the bowl. A character who succeeds on a DC 13 Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) check steals assorted coins worth **5 gp.** Each additional attempt increases the DC by 1. A character can steal up to **15 gp** from the bowl in total. If a character is caught stealing, they are immediately expelled from the pavilion by an angry mob and warned not to return. In the process, the character takes 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage from the crowd's rough handling.

Characters that decide to use the Search or Study actions can observe a few curious things.

- ***DC 12 Wisdom (Insight).*** The preacher is clearly playing to the crowd's desperation and superstition, encouraging donations and emotional reactions at every opportunity.
- ***DC 12 Intelligence (Investigation).*** The character notices a few of the "pilgrims" called to the stage appear to be planted performers rather than genuine volunteers. These individuals seem suspiciously prepared, stepping forward too quickly when asked for volunteers and exaggerating their ailments for the crowd.
- ***DC 12 Intelligence (Arcana).*** The supposed miracles are simple auditory and visual illusions, likely created with the *dancing lights* and *minor illusion* cantrips.
- ***DC 12 Wisdom (Perception).*** The character notices Waggledort is hiding near the back door, subtly casting spells while keeping out of sight of the crowd.
- ***DC 10 Wisdom (Animal Handling).*** The character notices that Lathander does not appear threatened at all and seems quite happy with the attention, happily snorting and wagging his curly tail.
- ***DC 12 Intelligence (Religion).*** Several aspects of the ceremony deviate wildly from the teachings of the Morninglord. For example, the sermons focus more on donations than faith or renewal.

If the characters interrupt the performance, the pavilion erupts into confusion. Many pilgrims assume the characters are troublemakers. Unless the characters present convincing proof of the scam or calm the crowd, nearby pilgrims attempt to force them out.

If violence breaks out, an angry mob of **eight commoners** forms to defend the disguised jackalwere and Lathander. At the start of rounds 2, 4, and 6, **two** additional **commoners** join the mob. To calm down or disperse the mob, a character must succeed on a DC 15 Charisma (Deception, Intimidation, or Persuasion) check, using whichever skill fits their approach. A character who casts *calm emotions* on the crowd has Advantage on this check. If at least half the commoners are knocked unconscious or slain, the mob breaks and the remaining pilgrims scatter.

If violence erupts, **three jackalweres** and **Wendelwella** (CE **doppelganger**) attack the party while the others flee from the scene. Against parties of Strong strength, Waggledort (**illusionist wizard**) joins the fight.

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ADJUSTING THE SCENE

Here are some suggestions for adjusting a scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Remove all **jackalweres** and reduce Wendelwella to 30 hit points.
- **Weak.** Remove **two jackalweres.**
- **Average. Wendelwella** (**doppelganger**), **three jackalweres, eight commoners.** Add an additional **commoner** at rounds 2, 4, and 6.
- **Strong.** Add **Waggledort** (**illusionist wizard**). If Waggledort is not there, add a small **gnoll pack lord**.
- **Very Strong.** Add a small **gnoll pack lord**.

ORDER OF THE GAUNTLET FACTION MISSION

If the characters successfully convince the angry crowd that the jackalweres are frauds, the miracle show collapses as doubt spreads through the pavilion. Exposing the deception and turning the crowd against the jackalweres fulfills the Order of the Gauntlet faction mission.

WHERE IS LE BOUCHER?

If the characters have aligned with Jacques le Boucher, the Malarite is not present in this scene. Earlier, he received a sign from Malar. Following the omen, Jacques wandered off to **area B6.** He returns later in **Part Three: Final Cut.**

DEVELOPMENT

Once the characters secure Lathander, the pig happily accompanies them back toward Longsaddle, seemingly unaware of the chaos surrounding the miracle show. If Lathander is killed, the encampment turns somber. Many pilgrims mourn the loss of what they believed was a divine sign. Some kneel in the mud to pray to the Morninglord, while others quietly gather their belongings and drift away.

If the Gogans are still present, they quickly realize that without the miracle hog there is no longer a crowd to swindle. The jackalweres pack their wagons and prepare to leave the area with whatever coin they have collected.

A TRUE MIRACLE

This option is available only if a character worships Lathander or openly offers a sincere prayer to the Morninglord. If Lathander the pig has been killed, allow the player to describe their character's prayer. The Morninglord, who has silently observed the entire spectacle of false miracles and misplaced faith, chooses this moment to answer with a genuine one. Warm golden light briefly washes over the pig's body, and Lathander rises back to life, snorting and behaving as if nothing had happened.

Once the characters resolve the situation with Lathander, they can return to Longsaddle. Ravenwing appears satisfied if the Gogan Brothers' operation has been disrupted. With the jackalweres scattered or defeated, Ravenwing then slips quietly back into the hills.

But Jacques le Boucher waits for the characters. The Malarite has not abandoned his prize and intends to claim the pig in the name of the Beast Lord. If Lathander is dead, Jacques instead marks the characters as prey and sets out to hunt them. Proceed to **Part Three: Final Cut.**



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Part Three: Final Cut

Estimated Duration: 45 minutes.

The way back to Longsaddle winds through muddy pastureland and narrow farm tracks. Split-rail fences and low stone field walls built from fieldstones divide the grazing fields while distant barns dot the countryside.

Story Objective

Defeating Jacques le Boucher is **Story Objective C.**

Le Boucher

As the characters cross the open farmland, Jacques le Boucher finally makes his move. Read or paraphrase the following:

> The muddy path winds between pasture fences and low stone walls as the rain falls in a cold drizzle. Ahead, a figure steps onto the path. A familiar figure slowly pulls back his hood, revealing his grim face beneath the falling rain. From behind the stone walls on either side of the path, enormous spectral boars move into view.

If Lathander is alive:

> "You have done well," the hunter growls. "You brought the offering exactly where it needed to go." His smile widens as the boars snort and paw the ground. "Now hand over the beast. The Beast Lord waits."

If Lathander is dead:

> "You robbed the Beast Lord of his sacrifice. No matter. Malar will accept another offering." The hunter bares his teeth in a cruel grin, "… that offering is you."

Area Information

Terrain. A muddy pasture path winds through rolling grazing fields bordered by split-rail fences and low stone field walls. Recent rain has churned the ground into thick mud, and the entire area counts as difficult terrain.

Walls. Low stone walls and simple split-rail fences made from rough wooden rails stacked between posts divide the pasture. The stone walls act as obstacles and provide half cover to creatures behind them. Creatures can also take half cover behind the split-rail fences.

Lighting. The sky is overcast and gray. During the day the area is in dim light beneath heavy clouds.

Weather. A cold drizzle falls across the pasture as a steady wind pushes rain across the fields.

Smells and Sounds. The air smells of wet grass, manure, and damp earth. Rain patters softly across the muddy ground.

Maps. Use **Map 3.1** for this encounter.

Creature Information

Jacques le Boucher (**scout captain**) confronts the characters from forty feet away with **two giant boars** at his side. The beasts appear faintly spectral, though they are fully tangible. These boars have the fiend creature type.

Earlier, the Malarite followed an omen from Malar that led him to a crude shrine to the Beast Lord hidden in the hills. There, Jacques received a blessing that allows him to call and command savage boars in the name of his deity.

Adjusting the Scene

Here are some suggestions for adjusting a scene. The adjustments are cumulative:

- **Very Weak.** Replace Jacques's stat block with a **scout**. Replace all **giant boars** with **four boars.**
- **Weak.** Replace Jacques's stat block with a **scout**. Remove **one giant boar.**
- **Average. Jacques le Boucher** (**scout captain**), **two giant boars.**
- **Strong.** Add another **giant boar**.
- **Very Strong.** Add another **giant boar.**

But he's Dead?

If Jacques was killed earlier in the adventure, he rises again as an undead creature driven by a relentless desire for revenge and the hunt. Replace Jacques's creature type with undead.

Treasure

If the characters loot Jacques le Boucher, they can find a longbow, a shortsword, studded leather armor, and a **Nature's Mantle** he recovered from the shrine at **area B6.** If the characters already claimed the cloak earlier, Jacques does not possess it.

Conclusion

When the characters return to Longsaddle, Posie rushes out to greet them the moment she sees Lathander. She throws her arms around the swine's neck, laughing and crying while the pig happily snorts and wags his curly tail. Posie thanks the characters repeatedly for bringing her champion home and promises to tell everyone that brave adventurers saved him from a gang of swindlers.

If Lathander was killed and the characters return his body, Posie grows quiet and gently rests a hand on the pig's side. Though heartbroken, she thanks the characters for bringing him home and promises to bury him near the cranberry bog where he spent his days.

Reward

As promised, Posie gives the characters her late father's **Cast-Off Plate Armor** with the **fragile quirk.**

If Lathander is dead and his corpse is brought back, Posie still honors her promise and gives the characters the armor, insisting Lathander would have wanted the heroes who tried to save him to have it.

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Rewards

At the **end of the session**, the characters receive rewards based upon their accomplishments.

Character Rewards

The characters earn the following rewards:

Advancement

A character participating in this adventure gains one level.

Gold

If found during the adventure the following items are converted to gold and added to any coins found during the adventure. The gold is split among the party members. If someone wants to keep an item in particular that character can either take it as part of their share, or pay for it with their own gold. Mundane items are not duplicated nor included in this.

Item	Gold Value
Posie's reward	100 gp
Merchant camp's money box	100 gp
Wendelwella's treasure chest	285 gp
Stealing from the collection bowl	15 gp
Maximum	500 gp

Equipment

The following mundane adventuring gear was found during the course of the adventure. Items are not duplicated. The party determines who receives an item unless an NPC or event during the adventure gave the item to a specific character.

Item	Gold Value
Priest's Pack	33 gp
Mace	5 gp
Holy Symbol (Amulet)	5 gp
Carpenter's Tools	8 gp
Cook's Utensils	1 gp
Leatherworker's Tools	5 gp
Painter's Supplies	10 gp
Weaver's Tools	1 gp
Disguise Kit	25 gp
Forgery Kit	15 gp
2 Healer's Kits	5 gp each
4 Fine Clothes	15 gp each
3 Dice Sets	3 sp each
7 Glass Bottles	2 gp each
Arcane Focus (Orb)	20 gp
Scholar's Pack	40 gp
Diplomat's Pack	39 gp
16 Traveler's Clothes	2 gp each
Scroll Case	1 gp
4 Studded Leather Armor	45 gp each
4 Shortswords	10 gp each
5 Longbows	50 gp each
4 Clubs	1 sp each
Maximum	755 gp, 3 sp

Spellbook

The following spellbook is described in **Appendix 3.**

- Waggledort Talonmist's Spellbook contains the following spells: *dancing lights, mage hand, minor illusion, disguise self, invisibility, mage armor, major image, phantasmal force,* and *phantom steed.*

Magic Item(s)

If found during the adventure, the characters can keep the following magic items; these items are described in **Appendix 3**:

- *Nature's Mantle (Repulsive Quirk)*
- *Cast-Off Plate Armor (Fragile Quirk)*
- *Spell Scroll of Antagonize*

Story Award

- *Faction Safehouse, Longsaddle*

This award is described in **Appendix 3**.

Dungeon Master Rewards

For running this adventure, you earn a DM Reward. See the *Adventurers League Dungeon Master's Guide* for more information,

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Creature Statistics

The following creatures appear in this adventure.

Boar

Medium Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 11 **Initiative** +0 (10)
Hit Points 13 (2d8+4)
Speed 40 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	13	+1	+1	**Int**	2	-4	-4
Dex	11	+0	+0	**Wis**	9	-1	-1
Con	14	+2	+2	**Cha**	5	-3	-3

Senses Passive Perception 9
Languages None
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Traits

Bloodied Fury. While Bloodied, the boar has Advantage on attack rolls.

Actions

Gore. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d6+1) Piercing damage. If the target is a Medium or smaller creature and the boar moved 20+ feet straight toward it immediately before the hit, the target takes an extra 3 (1d6) Piercing damage and has the Prone condition.

Boar of Malar
Change the boar's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Replace the boar's creature type with fiend.

Lathander the Pig
Change the boar's stat bock with the following adjustments:

- Reduce the boar's Hit Points to 6.
- It doesn't use Gore and doesn't have the Bloodied Fury trait. It has no effective attacks.

Commoner

Small or Medium Humanoid, Neutral
Armor Class 10 **Initiative** +0 (10)
Hit Points 4 (1d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	10	+0	+0	**Int**	10	+0	+0
Dex	10	+0	+0	**Wis**	11	+0	+0
Con	10	+0	+0	**Cha**	14	+0	+0

Gear Club
Senses Passive Perception 10
Languages Common
CR 0 (XP 10; PB +2)

Training. The commoner has proficiency in one skill of the DM's choice and has Advantage whenever it makes an ability check using that skill.

Actions

Club. *Melee Attack Roll:* +2, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) Bludgeoning damage.

Dire Wolf

Large Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 14 **Initiative** +2 (12)
Hit Points 22 (3d10+6)
Speed 50 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	17	+3	+3	**Int**	3	-4	-4
Dex	15	+2	+2	**Wis**	12	+1	+1
Con	15	+2	+2	**Cha**	7	-2	-2

Skills Perception +5, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15
Languages None
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The wolf has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the wolf's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Actions

Bite. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d10+3) Piercing damage. If the target is a Large or smaller creature, it has the Prone condition.

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Doppelganger

Medium Monstrosity, Neutral
Armor Class 14 **Initiative** +4 (14)
Hit Points 52 (8d8+16)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	11	+0	+0	**Int**	11	+0	+0
Dex	18	+4	+4	**Wis**	12	+1	+1
Con	14	+2	+2	**Cha**	14	+2	+2

Skills Deception +6, Insight +3
Immunities Charmed
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 11
Languages Common plus three other languages
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The doppelganger makes two Slam attacks and uses Unsettling Visage if available.

Slam. *Melee Attack Roll:* +6 (with Advantage during the first round of combat), reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (2d6+4) Bludgeoning damage.

Read Thoughts. The doppelganger casts Detect Thoughts, requiring no spell components and using Charisma as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12).

Unsettling Visage (Recharge 6). *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 12, each creature in a 15-foot Emanation originating from the doppelganger that can see the doppelganger. *Failure:* The target has the Frightened condition and repeats the save at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success. After 1 minute, it succeeds automatically.

Bonus Actions

Shape-Shift. The doppelganger shape-shifts into a Medium or Small Humanoid, or it returns to its true form. Its game statistics, other than its size, are the same in each form. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying isn't transformed.

Wendelwella Gogan

Change the doppelganger's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Alignment is chaotic evil.
- Her other languages are Abyssal, Gnomish, Thieves' Cant.

Giant Boar

Large Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 13 **Initiative** +0 (10)
Hit Points 42 (5d10+15)
Speed 40 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	17	+3	+5	**Int**	2	-4	-4
Dex	10	+0	+0	**Wis**	7	-2	-2
Con	16	+3	+3	**Cha**	5	-3	-3

Senses Passive Perception 8
Languages None
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Traits

Bloodied Fury. The boar has Advantage on melee attack rolls while it is Bloodied.

Actions

Gore. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6+3) Piercing damage. If the target is a Large or smaller creature and the boar moved 20+ feet straight toward it immediately before the hit, the target takes an extra 7 (2d6) Piercing damage and has the Prone condition.

Boar of Malar

Change the giant boar's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Replace the giant boar's creature type with fiend.

Gnoll Pack Lord

Medium Fiend, Chaotic Evil
Armor Class 15 **Initiative** +4 (14)
Hit Points 49 (9d8+9)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	16	+3	+3	**Int**	9	-1	-1
Dex	14	+2	+2	**Wis**	11	+0	+0
Con	13	+1	+1	**Cha**	9	-1	-1

Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
Languages Gnoll
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The gnoll makes two attacks, using Bone Whip or Bone Javelin in any combination, and it uses Incite Rampage if available.

Bone Whip. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 8 (2d4+3) Slashing damage.

Bone Javelin. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, range 30/120 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8+3) Piercing damage.

Incite Rampage (Recharge 5-6). The gnoll targets another creature it can see within 60 feet of itself that has the Rampage Bonus Action. The target can take a Reaction to make one melee attack.

Bonus Actions

Rampage (2/Day). Immediately after dealing damage to a creature that is already Bloodied, the gnoll moves up to half its Speed, and it makes one Bone Whip attack.

Jackalwere

Change the gnoll pack lord's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Small size.
- Replace their languages with Common and Thieves' Cant.

The gnoll pack lord is a jackalwere that remains in their hybrid form. To help disguise themselves, they don a cloak and hood.

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ILLUSIONIST WIZARD

Medium Humanoid, Any Alignment
Armor Class 12 (15 with mage armor) **Initiative** +2 (12)
Hit Points 44 (8d8+8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	9	-1	-1	**INT**	16	+3	+5
DEX	14	+2	+2	**WIS**	11	+0	+2
CON	13	+1	+1	**CHA**	12	+1	+1

Skills Arcana +5, History +5
Senses Passive Perception 10
Languages any four languages
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The illusionist makes two Arcane Burst attacks.

Arcane Burst. *Melee or Ranged Spell Attack:* +5, reach 5 ft or range 120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (2d10+3) psychic damage.

Spellcasting. The illusionist casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 13):

At will: *dancing lights, mage hand, minor illusion*

2/day each: *disguise self, invisibility, mage armor, major image, phantasmal force, phantom steed* (as an action)

BONUS ACTIONS

Displacement (Recharge 5-6). The illusionist projects an illusion that makes the illusionist appear to be standing in a place a few inches from its actual location, causing any creature to have disadvantage on attack rolls against the illusionist. The effect lasts for 1 minute, and it ends early if the illusionist takes damage, if it is incapacitated, or if its speed becomes 0.

JACKALWERE

Small Fiend, Chaotic Evil
Armor Class 12 **Initiative** +2 (12)
Hit Points 18 (4d6+4)
Speed 40 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	11	+0	+0	**INT**	13	+1	+1
DEX	15	+2	+2	**WIS**	11	+0	+0
CON	12	+1	+1	**CHA**	10	+0	+0

Skills Deception +4, Perception +4, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 14
Languages Common
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

TRAITS

Pack Tactics. The jackalwere has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the jackalwere's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The jackalwere makes two Rend or Slam attacks.

Rend (Jackal or Hybrid Form Only). *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6+2) Piercing damage.

Slam (Human or Hybrid Form Only). *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d4+2) Bludgeoning damage.

Sleep Gaze (Recharge 5-6). *Wisdom Saving Throw:* DC 10, one creature the jackalwere can see within 30 feet (Constructs and Undead succeed automatically). *Failure:* The target has the Unconscious condition for 10 minutes or until it takes damage or a creature within 5 feet of it takes an action to wake it. *Success:* The target is immune to this jackalwere's Sleep Gaze for 24 hours.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shape-Shift. The jackalwere shape-shifts into a Medium human or a Medium jackal-humanoid hybrid, or it returns to its true form (that of a Small jackal). Other than its size, its game statistics are the same in each form. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying isn't transformed.

GOGAN JACKALWERE
Change the jackalwere's stat block with the following adjustments:

- In addition to Common, they know Thieves' Cant.

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Scout Captain

Medium or Small Humanoid, Neutral
Armor Class 15 **Initiative** +5 (15)
Hit Points 66 (12d8+12)
Speed 30 ft., Climb 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	11	+0	+0	**Int**	14	+2	+4
Dex	16	+3	+5	**Wis**	15	+2	+2
Con	12	+1	+1	**Cha**	11	+0	+0

Skills Perception +6, Stealth +7, Survival +6
Gear Longsword, Shortsword, Studded Leather Armor
Senses Passive Perception 16
Languages Common plus one other language
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The scout makes two attacks, using Shortsword or Longbow in any combination.

Shortsword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d6+3) Piercing damage, plus 10 (3d6) Piercing damage if the attack was made with Advantage.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8+3) Piercing damage, plus 10 (3d6) Piercing damage if the attack was made with Advantage.

Bonus Actions

Aim. The scout has Advantage on the next attack roll it makes during the current turn.

Reactions

Uncanny Dodge. *Trigger:* The scout is hit by an attack roll. Response: The scout halves the damage (round down) it takes from that attack.

Orc Hunter
Change the scout captain's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Add darkvision 60 ft.

Jacques le Boucher
Change the scout captain's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Alignment is chaotic evil.

Scout

Medium or Small Humanoid, Neutral
Armor Class 13 **Initiative** +2 (12)
Hit Points 16 (3d8+3)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	11	+0	+0	**Int**	11	+0	+0
Dex	14	+2	+2	**Wis**	13	+1	+1
Con	12	+1	+1	**Cha**	11	+0	+0

Skills Nature +4, Perception +5, Stealth +6, Survival +5
Gear Leather Armor, Longbow, Shortsword
Senses Passive Perception 15
Languages Common plus one other language
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Actions

Multiattack. The scout makes two attacks, using Shortsword or Longbow in any combination.

Shortsword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d6+2) Piercing damage.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +4, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8+2) Piercing damage.

Orc Hunter
Change the scout's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Add darkvision 60 ft.

Jacques le Boucher
Change the scout's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Alignment is chaotic evil.

Weasel

Tiny Beast, Unaligned
Armor Class 13 **Initiative** +3 (13)
Hit Points 1 (1d4-1)
Speed 30 ft., Climb 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	3	-4	-4	**Int**	2	-4	-4
Dex	16	+3	+3	**Wis**	12	+1	+1
Con	8	-1	-1	**Cha**	3	-4	-4

Skills Acrobatics +5, Perception +3, Stealth +5
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 13
Languages None
CR 0 (XP 10; PB +2)

Actions

Bite. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 1 Piercing damage.

Familiar
Change the weasel's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Replace the weasel's creature type with fey.

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WEREWOLF

Medium or Small Monstrosity (Lycanthrope), Chaotic Evil
Armor Class 15 **Initiative** +4 (14)
Hit Points 71 (11d8+22)
Speed 30 ft., 40 ft. (wolf form only)

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	16	+3	+3	**INT**	10	+0	+0
DEX	14	+2	+2	**WIS**	11	+0	+0
CON	14	+2	+2	**CHA**	10	+0	+0

Skills Perception +4, Stealth +4
Gear Longbow
Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 14
Languages Common (can't speak in wolf form)
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

TRAITS

Pack Tactics. The werewolf has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the werewolf's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The werewolf makes two attacks, using Scratch or Longbow in any combination. It can replace one attack with a Bite attack.

Bite (Wolf or Hybrid Form Only). *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 12 (2d8+3) Piercing damage. If the target is a Humanoid, it is subjected to the following effect. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 12. *Failure:* The target is cursed. If the cursed target drops to 0 Hit Points, it instead becomes a Werewolf under the DM's control and has 10 Hit Points. *Success:* The target is immune to this werewolf's curse for 24 hours.

Scratch. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6+3) Slashing damage.

Longbow (Human or Hybrid Form Only). *Ranged Attack Roll:* +4, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 11 (2d8+2) Piercing damage.

BONUS ACTIONS

Shape-Shift. The werewolf shape-shifts into a Large wolf-humanoid hybrid or a Medium wolf, or it returns to its true humanoid form. Its game statistics, other than its size, are the same in each form. Any equipment it is wearing or carrying isn't transformed.

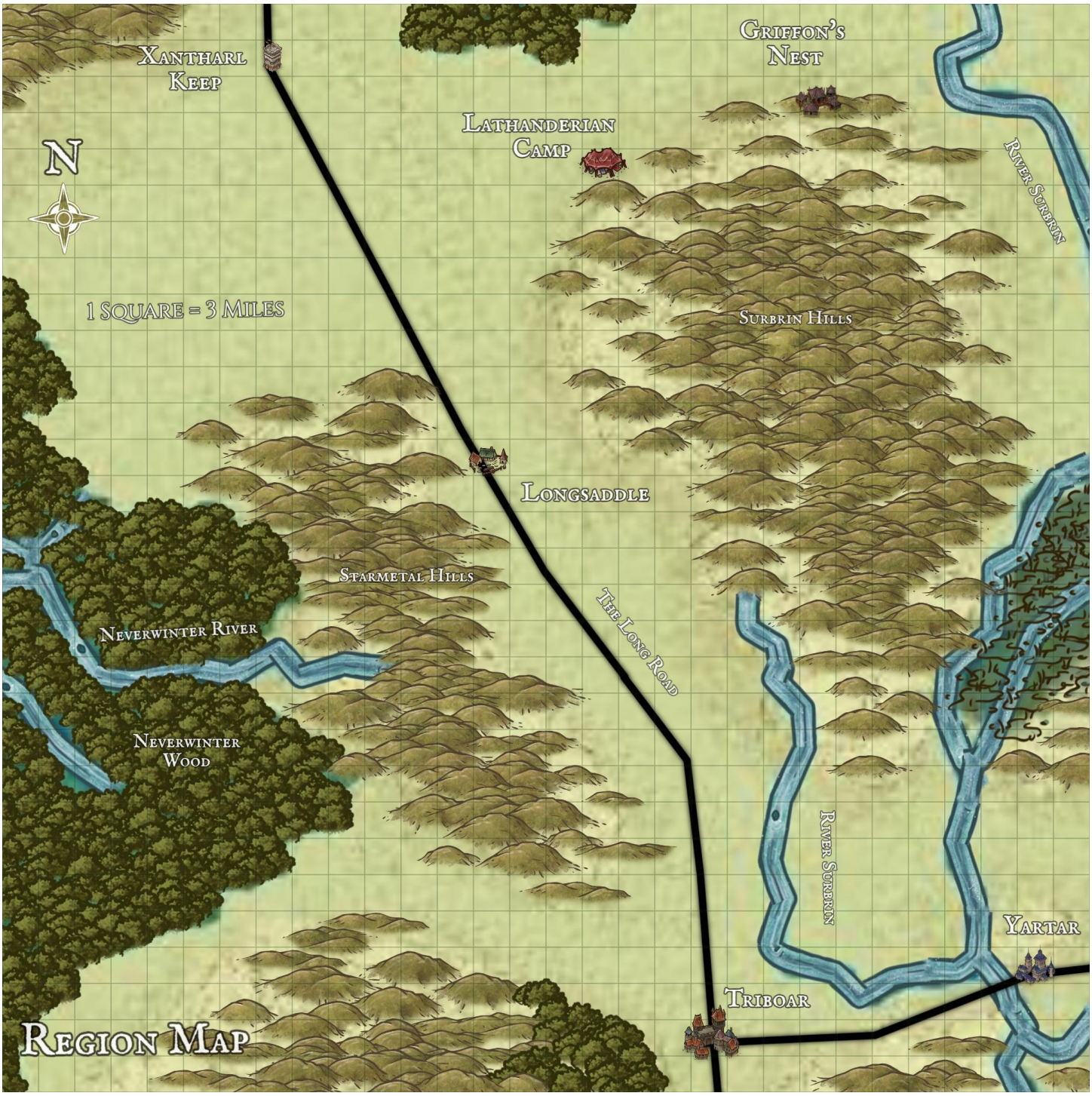
BIDDERDOO
Change the werewolf's stat block with the following adjustments:

- Alignment is chaotic good.

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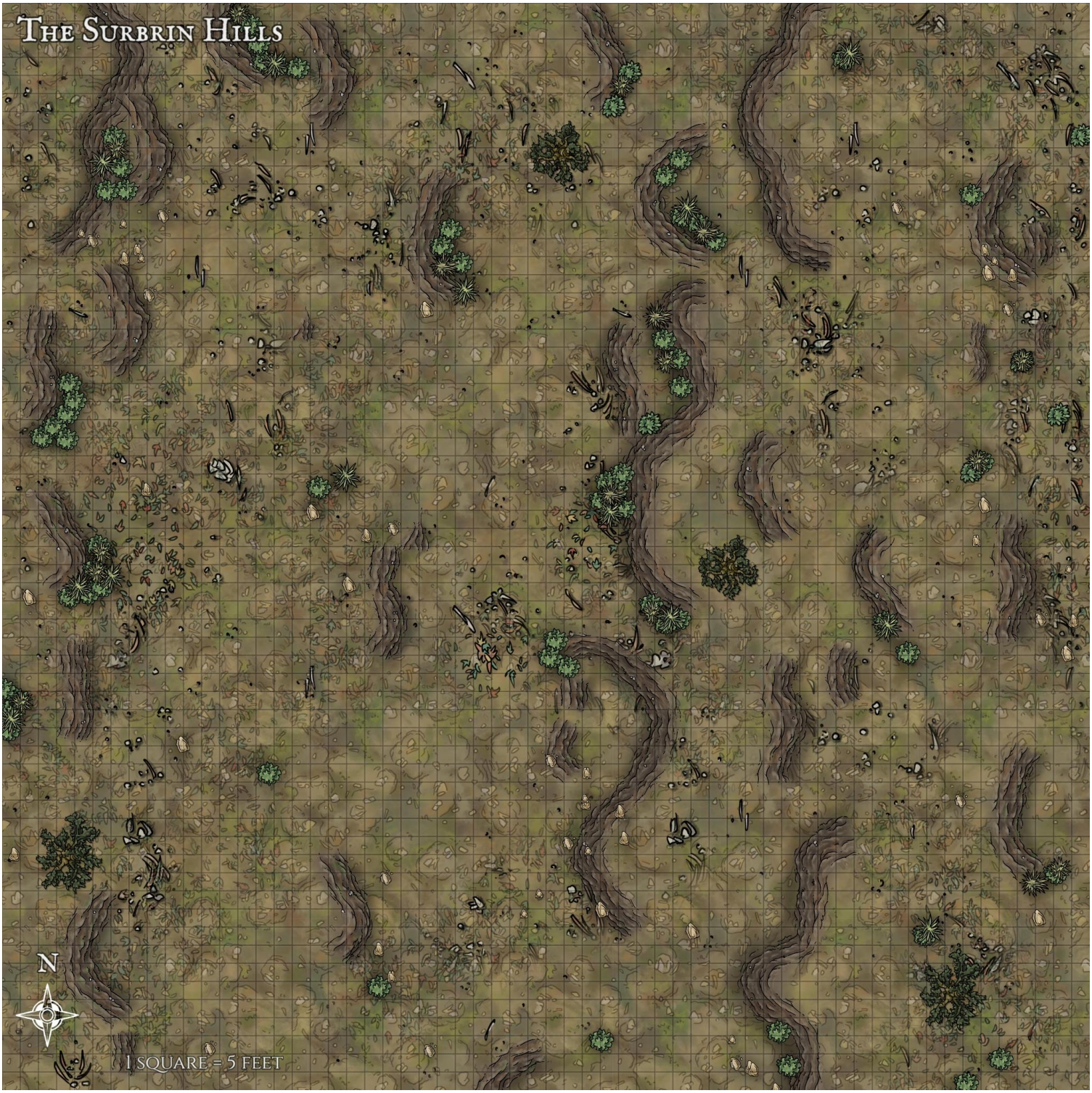
Appendix 1: Maps

Map 1.1 Region Map - 30x30



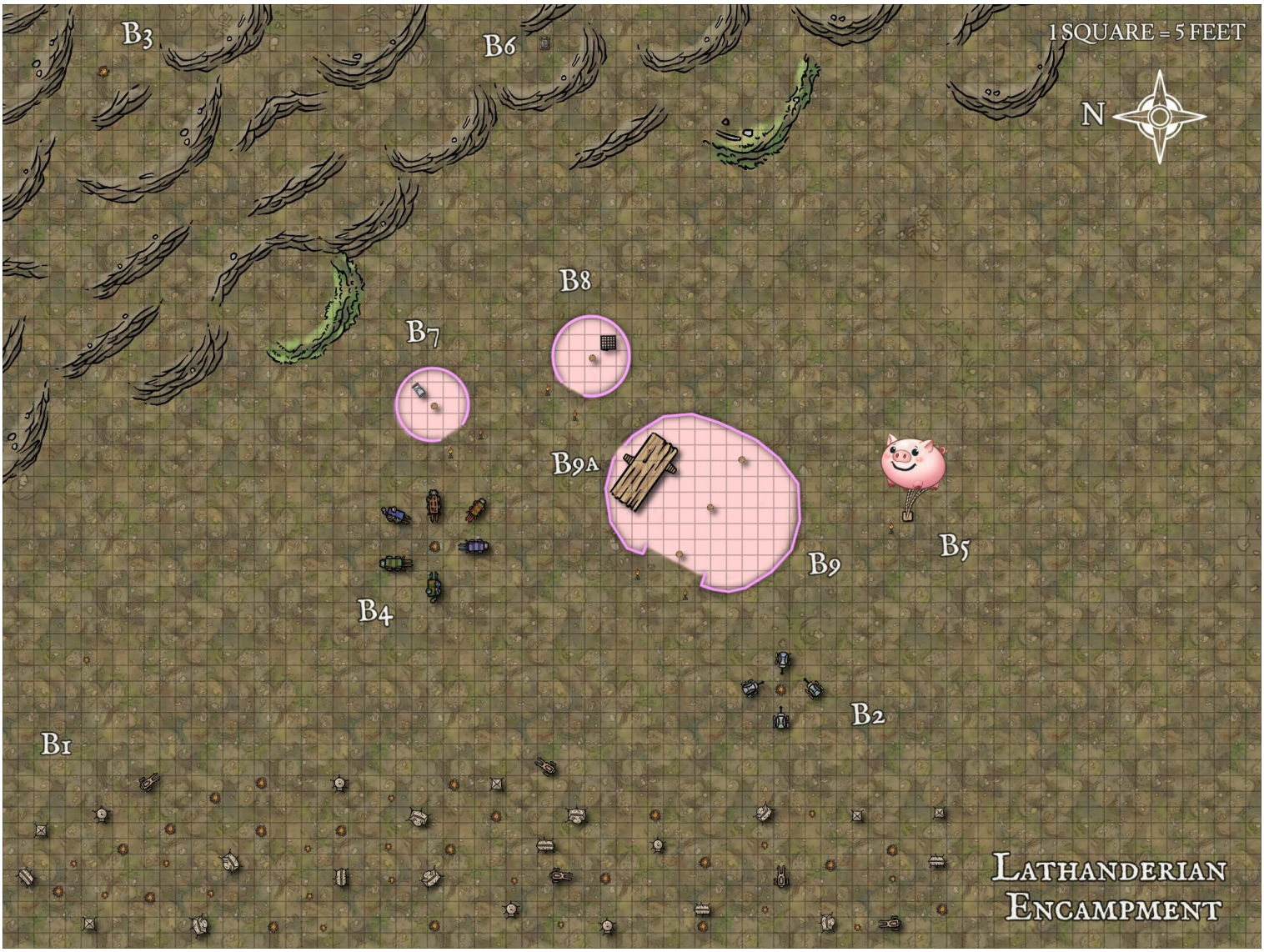
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Map 1.2 Random Encounter - 60x60



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MAP 2.1 ENCAMPMENT - 80X60



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Map 3.1 Muddy Path - 50x50



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Appendix 2: Handouts

Handout 1: The Gilded Horseshoe's Breakfast Menu

Gilded Horseshoe Breakfast Menu

Longsaddle Breakfast – 1 sp
Two fried eggs, thick cut bacon, skillet potatoes, and a heel of fresh bread with butter

The Special – 2 sp
A leg of turkey in mushroom, parsley, and garlic sauce

Biscuits & Gravy – 5 cp
Buttermilk biscuits smothered in sausage gravy

Endless Pancakes – 1 sp
Fluffy cakes topped with cranberry syrup and a pat of butter

Porridge – 2 cp
A bowl of porridge and a slice of warm brown bread

Rabbit Pie - 5 cp
A house specialty. Tender rabbit in a thick herb gravy baked beneath a golden crust, served hot from the oven

Drinks
Kaeth – 1 cp
Tea - 1 cp
Fresh milk - 2 cp
House Beer - 4 cp
Firewine - 2 sp
Zzar - 2 sp
Spirits - 3 sp

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HANDOUT 2: FACTION LETTERS

To those in service to order,

I am writing on behalf of the Lords Alliance. Reports speak of a band of Lathanderians claiming that an avatar of the Morninglord walks this region, healing the sick and injured. Investigate these claims, identify any organized wrongdoing, and secure proof if you are able. Act with discretion and restore order where needed. Report to me upon your return.

Dowell Harpell

Hail and well met.
I am Lara Stormrider, writing for the Emerald Enclave. Something is moving near the so called Lathanderian camp. I suspect one of the Bidderdoo, a society of lycanthropes that has long protected the Longsaddle region. They are not our enemies, but they keep to their own. Find them. Earn their trust if you can, and speak for the Enclave. We would see them as allies and welcome them to our cause. Once you have done so, find me at Griffonpost Manor.

LS

Stand firm in the Light,
I am Lanniver Strayl of Neverwinter, knight of the Order of the Gauntlet. Word reaches us of Lathanderians in this region claiming miracles and drawing the faithful to them. I do not trust it. Such claims often hide deceit, and the innocent are the ones who suffer for it. Go and investigate. If they are frauds, go among the pilgrims and show them the truth. Turn them from false promises, and set them back upon the righteous path. Do this with conviction, not cruelty. The Order stands for justice, not fear. When your work is done, return to the Longsaddle Post Office and post word of your deeds on the message board.

Protect the weak and crush the wicked

To Those Who Harp,
There are rumors of Lathanderians, the Wollwursts, claiming that Lathander, deity of the dawn, walks among us. Such claims are often false, but we must learn more. Determine whether this group is a cover for a larger criminal enterprise or cult. Among them are hired hands from Triboar. Find one who might be persuaded to act as an informant for us. Information and knowledge are half the battle against any foe. Once you have completed your task, go to the Gilded Horseshoe and report your success to this messenger. They will be waiting for your return.

Once you have read this letter, destroy it.

=

Greetings. Your talents have been noted.
There are rumors of Lathanderians, the Wollwursts, traveling the region and selling miracles to the desperate. We suspect they are little more than a band of charlatans, but possibly useful ones. Learn what you can of their operation. We believe they may be connected to other roaming bands of thieves and swindlers across the North. If so, this is not a small venture, but a network worth understanding. Identify one among them who can be turned. Coin, leverage, or quiet threats may prove effective. Secure their loyalty and make them useful to us. Once you have succeeded in this mission, go to the Night Cloak in Longsaddle and report your results to the Blue Dragon.

The Shadow

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Appendix 3: Character Rewards

If found during the adventure, the characters can keep the following magic items; it's suggested that you print off enough copies of this page to be able to give one to each of your players (crossing out rewards they didn't receive during the session):

Nature's Mantle

Wondrous Item, uncommon (requires attunement by a Druid or Ranger)

This cloak shifts color and texture to blend with the terrain surrounding you. While wearing the cloak, you can use it as a Spellcasting Focus for your Druid and Ranger spells.

While you are in an area that is Lightly Obscured, you can Hide as a Bonus Action even if you are being directly observed.

This item is found in the *Dungeon Master's Guide.*

Repulsive. You feel a sense of distaste when in contact with the item and continue to experience discomfort while bearing it.

The cloak carries a pungent boar musk odor that clings stubbornly to it. Curiously, the wearer is the only one who can smell it.

Cast-Off Plate Armor

Armor (plate), common

You can doff this armor as a Magic action.

This item is found in the *Dungeon Master's Guide*.

Fragile. The item crumbles, frays, chips, or cracks slightly when wielded, worn, or activated. This quirk has no effect on its properties.

This battered suit of plate armor has clearly seen better days. The metal is dented and scratched, the straps look hastily repaired, and several plates bear hairline cracks that suggest the armor might collapse at any moment. Despite its worn appearance, the armor remains surprisingly sturdy.

Waggledort Talonmist's Spellbook

Spellbook, equipment

The spellbook contains the following spells: *dancing lights, mage hand, minor illusion, disguise self, invisibility, mage armor, major image, phantasmal force,* and *phantom steed.*

Spell Scroll of Antagonize

Scroll, uncommon

A Spell Scroll bears the words of a single spell, written in a mystical cipher. If the spell is on your spell list, you can read the scroll and cast its spell without Material components. Otherwise, the scroll is unintelligible. Casting the spell by reading the scroll requires the spell's normal casting time. Once the spell is cast, the scroll crumbles to dust. If the casting is interrupted, the scroll isn't lost.

If the spell is on your spell list but of a higher level than you can normally cast, you make an ability check using your spellcasting ability to determine whether you cast the spell. The DC equals 10 plus the spell's level. On a failed check, the spell disappears from the scroll with no other effect.

The level of the spell on the scroll determines the spell's saving throw DC and attack bonus, as well as the scroll's rarity, as shown in the following table.

This item is found in the *Dungeon Master's Guide.*
This spell is found in *the Book of Many Things.*

- Spell DC 15

Antagonize

3rd-Level Enchantment
Casting Time: 1 action
Range: 30 feet
Components: V, S, M (a playing card depicting a rogue)
Duration: Instantaneous

You whisper magical words that antagonize one creature of your choice within range. The target must make a Wisdom saving throw. On a failed save, the target takes 4d4 psychic damage and must immediately use its reaction to make a melee attack against another creature of your choice that you can see. If the target can't make this attack (for example, because there is no one within its reach or because its reaction is unavailable), the target instead has disadvantage on the next attack roll it makes before the start of your next turn. On a successful save, the target takes half as much damage only.

At Higher Levels. When you cast this spell using a spell slot of 4th level or higher, the damage increases by 1d4 for each slot level above 3rd.

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Story Awards

The following story award may be earned based on the characters actions in the Adventure.

Faction Safehouse, Longsaddle

Through their service and loyalty, the character earns the trust of the faction's local agents and gains access to a discreet safehouse in Longsaddle. These locations allow faction members to rest, exchange information, and receive aid from trusted allies operating in the region.

- ***Lords' Alliance.*** A guest suite within Ivy Mansion, the residence of the Harpell family and a school for sorcerers and wizards. It serves as a meeting place for agents of the Lords' Alliance traveling through the region.
- ***Order of the Gauntlet.*** The Longsaddle Post Office serves as a refuge for the faithful and couriers traveling the Long Road. The building contains simple guest quarters and a message board used by the community and by traveling champions of the Order of the Gauntlet.
- ***Emerald Enclave.*** A guest suite at Griffonposts, the estate of the Stormrider family. Known throughout the region as skilled rangers and daring treasure hunters, the Stormriders support the Enclave's efforts to preserve the natural balance of the surrounding wilderness.
- ***Harpers.*** A private room within the Gilded Horseshoe's basement, Longsaddle's well known inn. The room provides Harpers with a discreet place to meet and trade rumors.
- ***Zhentarim.*** A guest suite at the Night Cloak, a festhall that caters to travelers seeking drink, music, and companionship. The Night Cloak serve as secure lodgings for Zhentarim agents conducting business in the frontier.



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Appendix 4: Dungeon Master Tips

To DM an adventure, you must have 3 to 7 players—each with their own character within the adventure's level range (see Adventure Primer). Characters playing in a hardcover adventure may continue to play too, but if they play a different hardcover adventure, they can't return to the first if they level beyond its level range.

New to D&D Adventurers League?

http://dnd.wizards.com/playevents/organized-play

https://yawningportal.dnd.wizards.com/

https://discord.gg/dnd

Preparing the Adventure

Before you start play, consider the following:

- Read through the adventure, taking notes of anything you'd like to highlight or remind yourself of while running the adventure, such as a way you'd like to portray an NPC or a tactic you'd like to use in a combat. Familiarize yourself with the adventure's appendices and handouts.
- Gather any resources you'd like to use to aid you in running this adventure—such as notecards, a DM screen, miniatures, and battlemaps.
- Ask the players to provide you with relevant character information, such as name, race, class, and level; passive Perception score, and anything the adventures specifies as notable (such as backgrounds, traits, and flaws).

Players can play an adventure they previously played as a player or Dungeon Master but may only play it once with a given character. Ensure each player has their character's adventure logsheet (if not, get one from the organizer) with their starting values for level, magic items, gold and downtime days. These are updated at the conclusion of the session. The adventure information and your information are added at the end of the adventure session—whether they completed the adventure or not.

Each player is responsible for maintaining an accurate logsheet. If you've time, you can do a quick scan of a player's character sheet to ensure nothing looks out of order. If you see magic items of very high rarities or strange arrays of ability scores, you can ask players to provide documentation for the irregularities. If they cannot, feel free to restrict item use or ask them to use a standard ability score array.

Point players to the *D&D Adventurers League Players Guide* for reference. If players wish to spend downtime days and it's the beginning of an adventure or episode, they can declare their activity and spend the days now, or they can do so at the end of the adventure or episode. Players should select their characters' spells and other daily options prior to the start of the adventure, unless the adventure specifies otherwise. Feel free to reread the adventure description to help give players hints about what they might face.

Adjusting This Adventure

To determine whether you should consider adjusting the adventure, add up the total levels of all the characters and divide the result by the number of characters (rounding .5 or greater up; .4 or less down). This is the group's average party level (APL). To approximate the **party strength** for the adventure, consult the table below.

Determining Party Strength

Party Composition	Party Strength
3–4 characters, APL less than	Very Weak
3–4 characters, APL equivalent	Weak
3–4 characters, APL greater than	Average
5 characters, APL less than	Weak
5 characters, APL equivalent	Average
5 characters, APL greater than	Strong
6–7 characters, APL less than	Average
6–7 characters, APL equivalent	Strong
6–7 characters, APL greater than	Very Strong

Safety Tools

Safety tools ensure that players aren't pushed beyond their comfort levels. They let your players know that you want them to have a positive experience. Some common safety tools are provided below—each with a summary of how they work. Make sure you discuss them with your players before the game.

There are a broad range of safety tools available for you and your players online, but for more information reach out to your Event Organizer or to community@dndadventurersleague.org.

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